

5.2a

The style of written English

Worksheet

- A** What is the difference between the first and second word in these pairs of words?

get/obtain Thanks/Thank you I'll/I will job/occupation about/with reference to

- B** Match each phrase on the left with a phrase on the right.

Informal (spoken) language

- 1 Thanks for your letter.
- 2 I've just seen your advert in ...
- 3 Can you tell me about ...?
- 4 because
- 5 Sorry, I can't make the meeting.
- 6 Here are ...
- 7 What exactly do you need?
- 8 Just send the stuff back. We'll pay.
- 9 I've got some bad news. There's no more until next month.
- 10 Good news! I've just heard that ...
- 11 There isn't much left. You better move fast.
- 12 If you'd like any more details, just let me know.

Formal (written) language

- a I am writing with reference to the advertisement in ..
- b due to the fact that
- c Thank you for your letter dated 14 March.
- d Please find enclosed ...
- e I am afraid I will not be able to attend the meeting.
- f I would be grateful if you could send me some information about ...
- g Please return the goods at our expense.
- h We are pleased to inform you that ...
- i Please let me know your exact requirements.
- j If you require any further information, please do not hesitate to contact me.
- k We regret to advise you that the goods you require are temporarily out of stock.
- l Please note that our stocks are limited. We advise customers to order as soon as possible to avoid disappointment.

- C** The phrases below are typical of informal spoken English. Rewrite them as sentences for a business letter. Some words have been given to help you.

- 1 It's about that ad. we saw in *Marketing Monthly*. (*writing/reference to/recent edition*)

- 2 Can you send us something about what your company sells? (*grateful/information/range*)

- 3 Thanks for your letter of March 12 asking about what we sell. (*dated/enquiring/products*)

- 4 I have some bad news. I'm afraid your order is going to be late. (*regret/inform/delayed*)

- 5 See you in Frankfurt next month! (*look forward*)

- D** Rewrite the sentences from section C as sentences for an e-mail. The style will be brief and direct.